

The Boston Globe

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Murder conviction in girl's death overturned

Court cites procedural issue; prosecutors vow to retry Harmony's father

By Steven Porter
GLOBE STAFF

The New Hampshire Supreme Court overturned Adam Montgomery's murder conviction on Thursday in the fatal beating of his 5-year-old daughter, Harmony Montgomery, citing a procedural flaw in how the case was tried.

Prosecutors vowed to retry the case, insisting they remain confident in the evidence that led to the 2024 conviction.

Montgomery, now 36, was convicted of second-degree murder for recklessly causing his daughter Harmony's death and of second-degree assault for an earlier incident of physical abuse. Prosecutors said the fatal incident occurred while the family was living in a car after they had been evicted from their home.

But the high court ruled that keeping those two charges together in a single case jeopardized his right to a fair trial.

The Supreme Court reversed Montgomery's conviction on the murder charge but affirmed his convictions for assault, falsifying physical evidence, witness tampering, and abusing his daughter's corpse.

Those convictions, combined with an earlier unrelated firearms case, mean Montgomery will remain behind bars, according to Jesse J. O'Neill, a lawyer who previously worked as a homicide prosecutor with the New Hampshire

MONTGOMERY, Page A7

AI-generated news enough for some on South Shore

By Aidan Ryan
GLOBE STAFF

The digital site South Shore News faced a significant test when founder Justin Evans put up a paywall in April: Would readers pay for artificial intelligence-generated articles that recap town government and school committee meetings?

As it turns out, the answer is yes. So far, Evans has 350 paid subscribers, many of whom are deeply invested in town politics and want to learn more about how neighboring towns from Weymouth down to Plymouth are tackling common issues. While the audience is still small, it's a sign that despite skepticism about the technology, there could be a larger audience for AI-generated local news — albeit with a limited focus.

The site has become a significant side hustle for Evans; he expects to generate \$25,000 in revenue this year against less than \$2,000 in costs, not counting his own time running the site — enough for him to think about expansion.

"It felt like a real make or break moment for

AI, Page A6

With the fans here at last, the party is definitely on



PHOTOS BY ERIN CLARK/GLOBE STAFF

Above, Scotland supporters burst into song at Hennessy's Bar in downtown Boston, while in Quincy, Haiti player Markhus Lacroix greeted the crowd as the team reached its hotel.



World Cup intensity hits home as massive crowds do their thing

By Chris Serres
and Omar Mohammed

GLOBE STAFF

and Thai Theodoro
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

World Cup fever finally arrived in Boston on Thursday in an early-morning burst of bagpipe music, colorful soccer jerseys, and kilts. Lot and lots of kilts.

By midmorning, the area around Faneuil Hall Marketplace was packed with Scottish soccer fans wearing the blue tartan of their cultural garb, many already 16 ounces deep into their celebrations.

Across City Hall Plaza, a massive crowd spilled out of the open doors of the Dubliner. Their chants of "No Scotland, No Party!" echoed a full block away, where public officials were holding a walk-through of the city's World Cup fan festival ahead of the first match at Gillette Stadium, Scotland vs. Haiti, on Saturday night.

And one Boston resident took to social media to complain of being woken at the crack of dawn by a kilt-clad bagpipe player.

Meanwhile, at a park in East Boston, workers inflated a 2,200-pound soccer ball at the site of another fanfest watch party. The giant sphere weighs as much as 20 kegs of Sam Adams beer and is expected to set a new world record. Later in the afternoon, fans of the Mexico national team gathered in the park to cheer on their team in a 2-0 win over South Africa in the first game of the tournament.

All across Greater Boston, boisterous tourists from Scotland, Haiti, France, and

FANS, Page A7

Helping to 'Lasso' in the casual fan

CHAD FINN



Getting ready

Foxborough businesses aren't quite sure what to expect this weekend. **B5.**

A big one

History says the US must not lose its opener today. **C1.**

Upon initial consideration, the lasting lessons of "Ted Lasso" are the frequent aphorisms and epigrams deployed by the title character on the Apple TV hit show about a big-hearted, open-minded, hopeful-but-silently-hurting Division 2 college football coach who heads to England to coach Premier League *football*.

Be a goldfish. (Don't let a bad experience or memory linger. Forget about it!)

Believe. (Reiterated in a sign affixed above the exit to his AFC

Richmond team's locker room.)

And perhaps the most popular one: Be curious, not judgmental. (Emphasizes one of the show's overriding themes: The

world is a better place when you keep an open mind, ask questions, and are willing to accept and even celebrate the people around you for who they are.)

"The show resonated because it's about people first and soccer second," said Ali Krieger, an American soccer legend who

FINN, Page C5

Ultimate Trump: cage fights at the White House



ALEX BRANDON/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Everything's in place for Sunday's event, which will be held on President Trump's 80th birthday. In the center of it all is the Octagon.

By Julian E.J. Sorapur
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — When he's encountered particularly difficult times during his political career, President Trump has turned to a reliable refuge: ultimate fighting.

Just months after the Jan. 6 riots at the Capitol, when Trump's political future was at its most uncertain, he popped up at an Ultimate Fighting Championship fight in Las Vegas. Two years later, days removed from pleading "not guilty" to 34 felony counts of falsifying business records in New York, Trump was again cage side at a UFC event in Miami, greeted by raucous chants of "USA." And again, in the year after, shortly after he

was found guilty on all 34 counts, Trump was cheered by a UFC crowd in New Jersey.

For a president with an eye for spectacle, who fancies himself a fighter above all else, the marriage is natural. Much of the UFC's overwhelmingly young, male audience also count themselves as part of his MAGA base. When general public opinion of Trump is low, he knows the UFC crowd, its fighters, and the company's top brass all have his back.

In short, it's Trump's safe space. And now, at a time when his approval ratings are near a record low, he's brought it to the White House's backyard.

On Thursday, I took in a surreal sight on the White House South Lawn: a 92-foot overlapping steel arch struc-

OCTAGON, Page A6

Alvin Campbell Jr., brother of Attorney General Andrea Campbell, was convicted of rape and sex assault charges. **B1.**



Strike zone

Friday: Hot, T-storms. High 84-89. Low 67-72.

Saturday: Less humid. High 84-89. Low 65-70.

High tide: 9:08 a.m., 9:25 p.m.
Sunrise: 5:07 Sunset: 8:21

Weather and Comics, G6-7. Obituaries, C11.

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\$4.00

A year after the shocking trade of Rafael Devers, the Red Sox still haven't made up for his bat. **C1.**

